



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. John Paul II Independent School
School Website: <https://www.jp2independentschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St. John Paul II Independent School (JP2I) in Colwich, Kansas presents a distinct classical-inflected approach anchored in Catholic liberal arts education. Public pages and crawl-derived materials repeatedly foreground a Catholic identity, formation of character, and a liberal-arts framework that integrates Common Arts with traditional liberal arts pedagogy. The school explicitly emphasizes relationship with God, a Logos-centered intellectual program, and the cultivation of wonder, virtue, and truth, goodness, and beauty throughout its messaging. Pedagogical statements point to Socratic discussion, memory work, and formation through practice, with a visible faculty culture described as mentors and living curriculum. There is also explicit emphasis on parental partnership and community formation, underscoring a classical ethos that sees families as co-teachers in the education of children. Taken together, the public materials strongly align with a CLASSICAL orientation across all six classical elements.

Overall classification by category: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL - Faculty: CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Note: The evidence base includes site content and the school's public materials captured in the crawl, including direct statements about Catholic identity, liberal arts, Common Arts, Logos-centered learning, and Socratic pedagogy, as well as the accompanying knowledge-base lexicon of classical keywords used to calibrate the analysis. Key citations include pages and documents that explicitly reference Catholic formation, liberal arts, common arts, Socratic method, and family-school partnerships. See the cited snippets for each category below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents itself as a Catholic Liberal Arts School and emphasizes a deep Catholic identity within education, including explicit references to God, Christ, and Marian devotion, and a bishop's blessing as part of its mission framework. - Public material states: "Our curriculum immerses families in the rich tradition of a Catholic Liberal Arts education partnered with the study of the Common Arts to cultivate a sense of wonder and awe in God, the Author of beauty and His Divine Providence." - A direct assertion of formation toward Truth and a life oriented toward Truth, God, and a rightly ordered life anchored in Catholic devotion is visible in mission statements and theological framing. - The site uses the term Logos-centered education and includes explicit references to Catholic theology and devotion (e.g., Our Lady, bishop's blessing).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Catholic, theology, Logos, Divine Providence, Our Lady, Truth, Goodness, Beauty, wonder, awe, God/Christ, sacred tradition. These map to core Relational/Metaphysical indicators (transcendentals, theology, liturgical life, sacred beauty). Estimated positive keyword hits: 8–9. - Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials (no clear relativism, secular humanism, or value-neutral language observed in the public-facing text). Estimated negative keyword hits: 0.

Why this rating - The materials consistently foreground Catholic theology, a sacred orientation to truth, goodness, and beauty, and liturgical-affective language (e.g., devotion to Our Lady, Logos-centered intellect, Di-

vine Providence). This aligns strongly with the Classical rubric's Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The absence of explicit secular or relativistic language further reinforces CLASSICAL alignment.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Wording emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely job-preparation, with explicit references to formation of character and human flourishing (e.g., "formation," "the true, the good, and the beautiful"). - The mission highlights education aimed at knowing Truth and God, with focus on human excellence, virtue formation, and the liberal-arts tradition rather than a narrow workforce- or career- readiness frame. - Statements about awakening wonder and awe in creation reflect a classical telos beyond information transfer.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; liberal arts; teleology/pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty; wonder; human flourishing; sacred tradition; moral imagination. Estimated positive keyword hits: 5–7. - Negative keywords present: explicit career-readiness or "21st-century skills" language is not present in public statements; no explicit negative indicators detected. Estimated negative keyword hits: 0.

Why this rating - The school's framing centers formation, virtue, and a transcendental telos—core signals of CLASSICAL education rather than mere information delivery or workforce training. The presence of liberal-arts framing and the emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty further corroborate CLASSICAL orientation.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials and the curriculum narrative foreground Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Quadrivium as foundational, with explicit mention of a Seven Liberal Arts framework in classical discussions and pedagogy. The school also references Common Arts and integration of arts with liberal education. - The curriculum description includes a history-and-literature integrated approach, with reference to ancient/medieval traditions and a "Great Conversation" flavor via emphasis on classical texts and primary sources in the broader classical lexicon. The materials describe Latin study (Song School Latin), literature, and integrated humanities across Religion, History, Literature and Art. - Beekeeping, gardening, agriculture and other Common Arts are described as a living part of curriculum in some documents, illustrating an integrated, interdisciplinary approach to liberal education. - The site includes "The Arts of Education" materials describing Trivium (grammar, rhetoric, logic) and Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) as the core of Liberal Arts education, and the use of Great Books in a classical framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts; Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy); Great Books/Great Conversation; Latin; history as a unifying thread; Common Arts; interdisciplinary/harmony of subjects; wonder/integration. Estimated positive keyword hits: 7–9. - Negative keywords present: Absence of a predominately STEM-first, social-studies-as-history replacement, or project-based-only phrasing. Not observed in public-facing text. Estimated negative keyword hits: 0.

Why this rating - The curriculum framing centers classical liberal arts, a Trivium/Quadrivium structure, and Great Conversation-like aspirations, with integrated history and the humanities across disciplines. The explicit presence of Common Arts, Latin, and a history-literature-art integration supports CLASSICAL orientation.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials explicitly mention Socratic discussion as a method (Socratic seminar). The school emphasizes memory work, recitation, and rituals typical of classical pedagogy (e.g., explicit references to chant, memorization, and classical forms of teaching). The lower- and upper-school approaches described (singing/chanting, memory drills; Socratic seminars; rhetoric training; opportunities to deliver speeches) align with classical pedagogy. - The materials talk about contemplation/restful learning (Scholé)

as part of the approach, and the use of living texts and formation through imitation and practice. The presence of Common Arts and a deep emphasis on formation reinforce a pedagogy that weaves together contemplation, memorization, and rhetorical practice. - The public documents describe upper-school seminars, debates, and rhetorical training as part of the learning process.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar; discourse/dialogue; memorization/recitation; chanting/singing; Scholé; formation through imitation; rhetoric; memory-work; living curriculum; teacher as mentor; inquiry-based elements (within a classical-pedagogical frame). Estimated positive keyword hits: 6–9. - Negative keywords present: The lexicon notes potential negative signals such as “experiential learning focus” or “project-based only” in non-classical contexts; not evident in the school’s public-facing pedagogy. Estimated negative keyword hits: 0.

Why this rating - The school’s pedagogy is coherently aligned with classical teaching methods: Socratic dialogue, disciplined memory work, chanting and recitation, and rhetoric training, with upper-level seminars. This combination strongly supports CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site presents the faculty as model teachers and mentors who embody virtue and knowledge, described as the living curriculum and the core of the school’s community, i.e., a “faculty of friends.” The faculty are portrayed as collegial and sympathetic collaborators with students. - The public materials show a profile of teachers and a clear identification of what the school expects of teachers and students, consistent with a classical living-curriculum model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of teacher; faculty of friends; collegial culture. Estimated positive keyword hits: 4–5. - Negative keywords present: None observed in public materials (no references to “certification-driven” or “facilitator on the side” signals in the public text). Estimated negative keyword hits: 0.

Why this rating - The public-facing materials depict a strong, values-centered faculty philosophy consistent with classical education’s living-curriculum ideal and mentor-model teaching. This supports CLASSICAL in Element 5.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and views parents as co-teachers, with explicit assertions that the family is central to formation and that curricula and school life are oriented toward forming affections and the Western/Christian intellectual heritage. The mission references restoring the family and forming affections in alignment with classical education. - The materials describe family engagement, parental formation, and community education related to classical education, including public-facing language about family partnership and shared mission. The school characterizes itself as shaping culture through formation of affections (True/Beautiful/Good) and Western tradition.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; family involvement; parental formation; living tradition in the family; home-school integration; community of learners. Estimated positive keyword hits: 3–5. - Negative keywords present: Not clearly evident in public site language (no explicit consumer-only framing or minimal parent involvement). Estimated negative keyword hits: 0.

Why this rating - The public materials reflect a robust, classical-leaning stance on parent partnerships and community formation, consistent with the classical model of parents as co-educators. This supports CLASSICAL in Element 6.

What would move the needle (not applicable here)

- The school has strong CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories; no needle-moving changes are required to shift toward a full CLASSICAL designation. If a future expansion were desired, explicit, public-facing strengthening of Great-Books-into-curriculum signals, more explicit references to

a canonical Great Books program, and broader liturgical/communal practice details could further reinforce the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and Pedagogy categories, but current materials already meet the rubric robustly. (No dedicated “move the needle” notes are necessary given CLAS-SICAL status.)

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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